

October

22



Justin Fashanu **1990**

Black British striker Justin Fashanu came out as gay, becoming the first professional footballer worldwide to do so. Also the first player to command a transfer fee of £1 million, he is remembered as a pioneer on and off the pitch.

Also on this day

1884 The Royal Observatory in Greenwich, UK, was established as the prime meridian or 0° longitude. It is an imaginary line used as the basis for the world's time zones.

2009 To help train medical staff, Japanese engineers revealed a robot that simulated the symptoms of a person sick with the H1N1 flu virus.

1850 Early Olympics

The Much Wenlock Olympian Games, an annual sporting competition that helped to inspire the modern Olympic Games, was launched in Shropshire, England. Local athletes competed in sports such as penny farthing cycling and blindfold wheelbarrow racing.



Born this day

1913 Robert Capa, Hungarian-American war photographer. He risked his life to report on conflicts such as World War II.

1952 Jeff Goldblum, US actor. He has starred in a number of huge Hollywood blockbusters, including *Jurassic Park* and *Independence Day*.

Sky-high pioneer **1797**

French balloonist

André-Jacques Garnerin became the first person to successfully parachute. Using a hot-air balloon, he rose to a height of 1,000 m (3,280 ft), before letting go of the balloon and parachuting down to Parc Monceau in Paris, France, landing shaken but safe.

